Part 1 Sequence

EAT PALEO- SAVE THE WORLD

Agricultural Sustainability from an Omnivores Perspective

DEDICATION

DEDICATION

Dear Kimberly,
I couldn't have done any of this without your continued support. Thanks for jumping with me--without the parachute.

PROLOGUE

PROLOGUE

You can't please everyone, but pissing everyone off is a piece of cake.
If you have picked up this book, prepare to seriously loathe my very existence or love me for having the balls to call it like I see it and skip the sugar-coated bullshit everyone is used to. As long as you think about the concepts in the book long enough to form a opinion on the subject-- long enough to at least make purchasing changes, I win-- no matter how pissed you may be. Duh, that's why I wrote this book. I want things to change.

Some people will have a hard time knowing that I used to be a hairstylist and went to business school, not agricultural school. They will ask how it is that I could possibly know anything about agriculture without having lived on a farm, or had formal schooling. In the words of Dwight D. Eisenhower, "Farming looks mighty easy when your plow is a pencil and you're a thousand miles from the corn field." Touche, Dwight. But I don't have to eat shit to know it doesn't taste like watermelon. Besides, I might just have a leg up on those that did go to school because I didn't have to deal with the brainwashing of the agricultural industries to develop my ideas on farming or sustainability. I just needed to have some common sense, and the ability to read. But just for the sake of getting to know me a little bit more personally, allow me to give you my back story and a little history-- and you might not care what I did in my past life, pre-Paleo Era.

Hi! My name is Karen Pendergrass and I had no idea I would ever care so much about food and food politics, farm animals, or sustainability. But then life took a strange turn for me in 2008, and these things just sort of happened to me. "Happened" is putting it nicely, it was more like they sucker-punched me in the face, duct-taped me to a chair and waterboarded me until I really thought about it long and hard-- and was finally ready to come out of the corner. When I finally did come out, I came out swinging.

From what I had understood I was doing all of the right things to take care of my body, I quit smoking the year before after a 10 year habit, I quit drinking alcohol except for in very small amounts on special occasions, and I began a new habit: exercise. I exercised *all of the time.* I exercised at least every day for an entire hour, though most of the times for 2 hours, and on some days I spent my time with a personal trainer who

would end up saving my life when all she was trying to do was help my mother with her allergies. It's funny how these things work themselves out.

I ate whole wheat bread, drank skim milk, and I didn't eat red meat so I bought fish and chicken from the grocery store because I knew that I needed some amount of protein. As a recovering Vegetarian, that was a huge step for me. I also ate soy-protein bars because they contained a minimal amount of calories, and were cruelty-free. Well, almost cruelty-free, the taste was torturous.

I was diligent about brushing and flossing my teeth, drinking water, and from what anyone could tell I was in excellent shape and in excellent health. I was 110 pounds, size 0, 5'5 and relatively toned, and I worked hard to keep myself that way. By appearance alone, I looked healthy. Unfortunately, looks can be deceiving. Seriously, look at that DuranRider guy... he will serve as my case in point.

October 31st, 2008 was the first day that I looked as unhealthy as I actually was. It was also the first Halloween in my *entire* life that I didn't celebrate. It's hard to explain what a big deal that was to me, unless you knew that this is one out of the two days a year that I plan for months in advance. The other is St. Patricks Day. I wouldn't miss the other holidays if they fell off the calendar-- not even my own birthday. Not going out on Halloween was a big deal.

The reason I didn't go out that night because the costume that I had didn't fit that night, and neither did my shoes. Alright, now imagine what it would look like if the Stay-Puft marshmallow from Ghostbusters was 7 months pregnant. Got the picture in your head? Ok. That was me. That's why I didn't go out. I'm vain like that.

The next morning when I got out of bed I was dizzy with a headache, and when I got up it hurt to *walk.* For months this pain continued and worsened, along with all sorts of new symptoms but the one in particular that made no sense was that I was gaining weight-- *quickly*. So naturally (vain girl that I am) I began to eat like a bird and exercise more, but despite my grandest of efforts I continued to gain weight so I saw a physician.

She was less than awesome. This muffin explained to me that the weight was simply that I was taking in too many calories, and not making enough caloric expenditures, you know, the whole calories in-calories out theory. When I told her my exercise routine and my newly-formed eating habits along with my weight gain, she dismissed me completely. She explained to that I was having what she called "psychosomatic manifestations" which she blamed on "emotional stress." To be honest, she was right. I was stressed from incessantly trying to tell her that her calories-in calories-out theory was complete bullshit, trying to get some sort of validation or answer for my condition.

Fast-forward about 6 months, 30 some-odd doctors visits and 30 pounds later. I no longer had menses, experienced daily swelling of my legs, hands, feet and face, couldn't wear shoes except for flip-flops, couldn't walk, couldn't feel my legs, my skin hurt to the touch like I had a sunburn, I slept 20-36 hours straight and was only awake

while pumping my veins full of coffee and RedBull. I was a listless zombie. I was in a fog, I couldn't focus for the life of me. I had to constantly be reminded about what I was talking about during conversations. I would walk into rooms of my house and stand there, wondering what I was there for. Telling this stuff to my doctor was a mistake, she only thought I was crazier. My panicked attempts to figure things out and persistent scheduling only cemented this in her mind. She had decided that I was so crazy that I could manifest physical swelling, a loss of my period, and a weight gain of 30 pounds, and I couldn't control what was happening to my body.

"Stress, likely Depression," she decided. "I am going to prescribe an anti-depressant to help you" she said.

I snapped. "Do you know me!?!" "I am depressed *now* because I am gaining all of this weight and I'm fucking lost inside of my own head, I can't wear shoes or stay awake and yes, *that* is stressful!" and then, ever so politely, I said "I hope you get strangled by a stethoscope." Exit, stage right.

I know I should have left her a long time before that and found another physician, but remember I wasn't thinking clearly, either. So I went to another doctor, this time an internal medicine guy who prided himself on his "investigative work" and assured me he would "Get to the bottom of it." He was sure he would find the answer.

During my first visit I explained the symptoms with my mother sitting right beside me so she could at least attest to the validity of my statements, and so he had some blood work drawn up. A couple of days later, I got a call from his secretary and she said I needed to come back in immediately. I was told that I needed IV hemoglobin, red meat, ferrous sulfate, and to eat more because I was basically dying of malnutrition. It appeared that my body had just quit taking in nutrients from my food.

Shaking his head the internal medicine doc told me, "Your last doctor was an idiot." He got no argument there.

A couple months later I still hadn't seen any major improvement in my condition. He told me to eat more red meat, spinach, kale, and fish. I told him that I had been eating those foods daily but for some reason he didn't believe me, and told me that if I had been eating those foods I'd have surely gotten much better. My roommate at the time, Roxanne, vouched for me that those were, indeed, the foods that I had been eating. He told me to eat more.

Realizing that the doctors were missing something and my condition progressively worsened, my mother Kimberly asked my dad for help in figuring out what was wrong with me. Looking for an answer, my father stumbled upon Celiac's disease and suggested that I get tested for it. So, at my very next doctor's visit, I asked for the blood test.

Part 1 Sequence

My doctor said, and I quote, “You don’t have Celiac’s Disease. It’s a rare, wasting disease. You on the other hand, are gaining weight. That’s *not* it.” I said, and I quote myself here, “Give me the damn test.” A few weeks later the results were in. I got a phone call with the parting words of “Don’t eat wheat.” Gee, thanks Captain Obvious. I was asked to find another physician, too. Perhaps he didn’t like the fact that his “investigative” skills were upstaged by a hairstylist. What a blow to his ego!

When Kimberly and I tried the Paleo Diet before I was not at all strict. I still ate whole wheat bread and pasta, oatmeal and corn, rice and quinoa-- obviously I didn’t take it too seriously. But after my diagnosis, I was strictly on the Paleo Diet because I knew that it was an inherently gluten-free diet, and still at that juncture I had an immature understanding of the merits of the Paleo Diet in terms of my own health.

Within 8 days of a strict Paleo Diet, my legs turned pinker, my skin wasn’t so gray, it didn’t hurt to touch my skin, and I started sleeping 10 hours as opposed to 20. Within a month I felt like I had finally started making a real recovery. Swelling was down, the fog had lifted, and the weight had started to come off! Yay, me! Yay, Paleo!

But then I did something incredibly stupid. As an optimist (or idiot, whatever), I truly believed that with “mind over matter” I could go to France with some friends from school and eat whatever I wanted to while I was there. I thought “Hey, I’m on vacation! I do what I want!” Unfortunately, I became incredibly ill and my “mind over matter” experiment didn’t work. My friends demanded that I see a local doctor, which of course I refused because I no longer trusted doctors. I gained every bit of weight back (plus some) within the space of 2 weeks, and had been in more pain than I had ever been before. Also upon my return, my family was horrified by my “Stay Puft” appearance. So I went back to my Paleo Diet, and GI function returned after being at a painful standstill for weeks, but my body didn’t bounce back and return to normal this time.

I began noticing sensitivities to everything that I ate. It was not just wheat, and not just grains, and not just soy or dairy that I was sensitive to-- meat was making me sick. The Organic Chicken made me sick, the Organic Turkey made me sick, and God forbid I ate bacon -- I thought I was going to die. My last hope, the so called “grass-fed” beef was also making me incredibly ill. The random stabbing pains and swelling returned with a vengeance and I hadn’t even touched wheat in months. I was afraid I was going to lose my mind. I couldn’t believe I wasn’t getting better, or what I had done to myself over a croissant. Such a sob story-- but this is my back story.

Although this explains some of my medical history (gruesome details have been omitted), it doesn’t explain why this book was written by me. But there is one particular moment, however, that does. It was in September of 2009 while grocery shopping with Kimberly at a Whole Foods in Overland Park, Kansas. I was standing in front of the meat counter, scanning the meat section. Looking over the chicken, the turkey, the pork, the lamb and then the beef, I turned to Kimberly and remarked, “This doesn’t make any sense whatsoever. The very thing that is supposed to be making me better is making me sick. Is it even possible to be allergic to everything?

Part 1 Sequence

Kimberly says “Yeah. It is”

I ask the butcher: “Excuse me, are you sure that this beef is grass-fed?”

He says: “Yeah, it’s grass-fed”

I say: “Ok, But are you sure it’s 100% grass-fed? I’m having somewhat of a reaction to it.”

He says “It is grass-fed but it’s grain finished for the last three months.”

I say: “What?! That completely negates the purpose of it being grass-fed!”

He says: “Well they have to, so that they can get the proper nutrition before they go to market. Just eating grass isn’t enough for them to be healthy.”

Kimberly says: “If they are feeding them grain to fatten them up, how can you even call it grass-fed?”

I say: “That’s complete and utter bullshit, yo. Who the told you that eating grass isn’t enough?”

Kimberly: “That’s completely misleading.” She turns to me and said “It’s probably something that their corporate HQ told them, it’s a top down issue.”

Karen: “ It’s all corn-fed! No wonder it’s making me sick! How is it even legal for them to call it grass-fed? What a bunch of bullshit!”

At that moment my head exploded. It dawned on me that there were people that had been profiting off of my ignorance for *years*. There are people that profit from deceptive marketing practices. There was a much bigger picture out there, and I knew nothing about it. I simply wasn’t educated, but I was sick. In order for me to get better, I had to get educated. I also realized that there were people who *were* doing things the right way for the right reasons-- but *I* wasn’t investing in *them*, and it’s unlike me not to root for the underdog. I knew there were farmers out there who had what I needed to make me healthy again-- but I had no idea where to look or how to identify them. It took me years to figure it out.

Now I wish I would have taken the pill that would have re-inserted me happily back into the Matrix--because this rabbit hole runs deep. But I had to do *something* if I ever had any hope of getting back into my skinny jeans.

A few days after that incident at the meat counter was the birth of Paleo Approved, the best plan I could come up with for changing our food systems and the world. Time has

yet to tell whether or not I have succeeded or failed miserably, but Eat Paleo, Save The World is part of that plan. It is my overture to the world, pleading my case for all to actively make an impact on the current state of our food affairs. And by active, I mean eat Paleo. Because as I discovered, putting your health at the forefront of your concerns will render a healthier planet. Optimal Human Health leads to sustainability-- which I will argue in subsequent chapters.

I'm glad you are reading this right now, whoever you are. I'm glad you are taking the time to get my perspective, so I can have some sort of cosmic validation for my life, and reason for my illness. Thank you for giving me this opportunity to stand for something.

I figure if you aren't standing for something-- then you're sitting down. You can be a Food activist or inactivist-- your choice.

THE GAIA HYPOTHESIS

"The Gaia hypothesis says that the temperature, oxidation state, acidity, and certain aspects of the rocks and waters are kept constant, and that this homeostasis is maintained by active feedback processes operated automatically and unconsciously by the biota."- James Lovelock, *The Ages of Gaia*

The Gaia hypothesis is a theory formulated by the chemist James Lovelock and Co-founded by microbiologist Lynn Margulis in the 1970s that suggests that all organisms and their physical, inorganic surroundings create a complex system that maintains the homeostatic living conditions for all life forms on the planet. Scientific study of the Gaia hypothesis "focuses on observing how the biosphere and evolution of life forms contribute to the stability of global temperature, ocean salinity, oxygen in the atmosphere and other factors of habitability in a preferred homeostasis."

Though the theory was initially lambasted by the general scientific community, it is currently studied in several scientific disciplines which include geophysiology, Earth System science, biogeochemistry, and systems ecology. The Gaia hypothesis is an ecological hypothesis, and an evolutionary hypothesis-- all living things are complexly tied to another on this planet.

As you can imagine, the Gaia hypothesis has some principles that can be tied in with sustainable agricultural practices, because not only does sustainable agriculture honor a complex system of co-habitation and biodiversity, it also honors evolution.

According to Margulis and Lovelock, "The Gaia hypothesis states that the lower atmosphere of the earth is an integral, regulated, and necessary part of life itself. For hundreds of millions of years, life has controlled the temperature, the chemical composition, the oxidizing ability, and the acidity of the earth's atmosphere" (Margulis, L and J. Lovelock. 1976. "Is Mars a Spaceship, Too?" Natural History, June/July pp. 86-90)

Part 1 Sequence

We know that our current food systems are changing the earth's temperature and chemical composition, it's oxidizing ability, and the acidity of the earth's atmosphere. What has happened that has caused a rift in the complex system? Some want to sum it up as just another episode of the earths heating and cooling process. I'm going to disagree.

We know that climate has changed for eons, the earth has experienced numerous episodes of global cooling and warming, but it could also warm significantly due to a more recent change in atmospheric conditions.

Scientist suggest that despite the global cooling and warming that over the past billion years the earth hasn't changed it's temperature much, and that it likely wasn't ever more on average 15 degrees warmer, or even 5 degrees cooler than it is today. These changes were likely caused by greenhouse gasses such as methane, ammonia, and carbon dioxide.

Take into consideration that the sun currently emits 25% more heat than it did 4 billion years ago. You would think the entire planet would have been frozen, but due to life that existed on the planet, such as bacteria that emitted greenhouse gases, it was kept warm enough to sustain life, according to Lovelock and Margulis.

Greenhouse gases do, in fact, alter atmospheric temperature patterns. Write that down.

Now the sun emits 25% more heat energy than it did 4 million years ago. Why the hell aren't we burning up to a crisp here? Lovelock and Margulis argue that when the earth began to warm, it began to foster an environment for plankton production which removed Carbon Dioxide from the atmosphere, and when the plankton died carbon dioxide was sequestered-- as sediment.

Life forms, from cows to bacteria influence the amount of greenhouse gasses that exist in the atmosphere. The radical view that Lovelock and Margulis espoused is this: life regulates the physical and chemical makeup of the environment for the purpose of life itself. If this is true, then the planet is a complex, integrated living system with the capacity to self-regulate, and that everything is connected in this system. This is what is referred to as the "Strong Gaian Model."

Jim Kirchner who believes that there are many Gaian Hypotheses which stem from the Gaia Hypothesis:

Influential Gaia: suggests that all biota largely influence the temperature and the chemical composition of the atmosphere.

> "The Gaia hypothesis.. states that the temperature and composition of the Earth's atmosphere are actively regulated by the sum of life on the planet" (Sagan and Margulis, 1983).

Part 1 Sequence

Co-Evolutionary Gaia: suggests that the biota influence their abiotic environment, and that the environment in turn influences the evolution of the biota through a Darwinian process.

> "The biota have effected profound changes on the environment of the surface of the earth. At the same time, that environment has imposed constraints on the biota, so that life and the environment may be considered as two parts of a coupled system" (Watson and Lovelock, 1983).

Homeostatic Gaia: suggest that the biota influences the abiotic in a way that stabilizes it. If the biota is rendered unstable, everything else will be rendered unstable.

> "The notion of the biosphere as an active adaptive control system able to maintain the earth in homeostasis we are calling the 'Gaia' hypothesis" (Lovelock and Margulis, 1974).

Teleological Gaia: suggest the that the atmosphere is kept in a homeostatic state not just simply by the biosphere, but for the purpose of having a biosphere period.

"The Earth's atmosphere is more than merely anomalous; it appears to be a contrivance specifically constituted for a set of purposes" (Lovelock and Margulis 1974).

Optimizing Gaia: suggest that the biota will alter their own physical environments to create conditions which are favorable for themselves.

"...it is unlikely that chance alone accounts for the fact that temperature, pH and the presence of compounds of nutrient elements have been, for immense periods, just those optimal for surface life. Rather, ... energy is expended by the biota to actively maintain these optima" (Lovelock and Margulis, 1974).

Now you have to ask, are we Optimizing Gaia, or are we mindlessly fucking ourselves over?

Part 1 Sequence

VEGETARIANS SHOULD NOT WRITE ABOUT AGRICULTURAL SUSTAINABILITY

The truth may be puzzling. It may take some work to grapple with. It may be counterintuitive. It may contradict deeply held prejudices. It not be consonant with what we desperately want to be true. But our preferences do not determine what's true." Carl Sagan

Sometimes we become so engrossed with an idea or piece of information that it becomes the lens with which we filter all other information through, and our ability to assess information rationally may be completely lost when this occurs. I am only pointing this out because this is the only way I can make sense of the shit that I have seen written about Agricultural Sustainability by V*getarians.

Now, there is nothing inherently wrong with being a V*getarian, the ones I know genuinely care about their health and the well-being of the planet and the animals on it. I just want them to stop trying to put forth plans for agricultural sustainability which engenders an entirely Vegetarian lifestyle. Spoiler alert: Agricultural Sustainability comes from a focus on bioregionalism that facilitates wildlife and livestock production in tandem with crop production, and it excludes monocultures of cereal grains, staples of most Vegetarian cuisine. Besides, 7 billion people living off of tofu and granola is a terrible idea, and it sounds miserable.

So If you ever pick up a book about the morality of Vegetarianism in the context of agricultural sustainability-- put it back down and save yourself the headache. I wish I had. If you pick up a book on Agricultural Sustainability where the author specifically states that they don't want to bog the book down with science, put that one down too. It's an even bigger load of shit. It's more Vegetarian propaganda disguised as "Agricultural Sustainability" as if this world didn't have enough. What a waste of trees.

Now this is just my opinion, but I don't think that we get to ignore science when making recommendations for the future of the planet based on a moral bias. And by science, I specifically mean the fact that humans are omnivores.

Every single 8th grade Biology book ever published indicates that the homo sapiens sapiens species (that's us) are classified as *omnivores.* The sustainable books I have read that were written by V*getarians included cherry-picked literature in support of a V*getarian planet, not an *omnivorous* one. They are written under the guise of "Getting back to Nature," which is a joke. Mother Nature really doesn't seem to care about the moral "high-road" of V*getarianism as evidenced by the Great-White Shark, the T-Rex, and my cat Flip that kills anything that moves and puts it in my shoes.

Part 1 Sequence

Vegetarianism is a personal choice or a discipline, but omnivorism is a fact of human life. Simply put, if a horse is starving and you put a cooked steak in front of it, it will continue to starve not as a personal choice, but because horses are herbivores and don't eat meat. A tiger can die of starvation in a field of grass, also not a personal choice. It's a tiger. But a starving *human* given a plate of steak will eat it, and gain nourishment from it, and survive. The human that doesn't eat the steak in a starving state is making a personal choice, not a biological one, however unfortunate and senseless. Some animals have to eat other animals to live-- I am pretty sure this was the concept they were trying to drive home in The Lion King with "The Circle of Life" song.

You know who never saw the Lion King? People in Bhutan.

This country is interesting because almost everyone there farms, and they produce enough food to feed not only themselves, but enough to export to India. Bhutanese people practice a form of Buddhism that doesn't allow the consumption of animals or the use of them as draft animals, or working animals. These people get plenty of exercise and sun, and everyone takes part in the process of producing food. This is what the Vegetarian version of a sustainable Planet is-- a self-contained society that plants rice, wheat, legumes, chili peppers, and vegetables without the aid or consumption of animals. It sounds *so* idyllic, like butterflies, waterfalls and unicorns. It's PETAs wet dream.

But seriously, Bhutan is my case-in-point against this notion of a Vegetarian planet. You see, Bhutan has a problem. According to the World Bank, Bhutan has some major health issues. Sixty-two percent of the "disease burden," and the "major" issues in Bhutan are "cardiovascular diseases, mental health (neuropsychiatric conditions) respiratory diseases, cancer, and diabetes. "Ministry of Health assessments, using primarily institution-based patient diagnoses, find increasing trends for hypertension, diabetes, and cancer."

You mean there's an entire country full of vegetarians living a "sustainable Vegetarian life" that's dealing with hypertension, heart disease, mental health disease, cancer, diabetes, and neuropsychiatric conditions? No shit?

Time to watch the Lion King, people of Bhutan.

What also bothers me about the vegetarian approach to sustainability is how many omnivores around the world don't even entertain the idea of living "sustainably" because they fear that it means they can't have steak, eggs, and bacon for breakfast without a twinge of guilt. If we want to explore one-size-fits-all sustainability, it is imperative that we take the omnivorous approach. Besides, the last time we were sustainable as a planet, we were all omnivores. And I'd like to have my bacon and eat it

too. But don't accuse me of being cruel for my insatiable appetite for wild boar bacon if you're a snooty PETA fan. I'm about to knock you off that high horse.

Right now.

VEGETARIANISM DOESN'T PREVENT ANIMAL CRUELTY

I usually don't say much about PETA, but then I recently read the headlines of their Go Vegetarian, Go Vegan Magazine. Headlined was: Everything you need to eat right for your health, for animals, and for the Earth." I am convinced that they wrote that specifically for me, just to see what would happen if I went postal.

Oh, PETA. You people suck harder than a vacuum sucks hairballs. About 2 years ago I had a ongoing email exchange from a woman who was a marketing director for PETA. I was mistakenly hoping that they could get behind the concept of Paleo Approved, an eco-label that I created, because my goals entailed reducing animal cruelty by helping the market for small and medium-sized farmers flourish, and push the market away from Concentrated Animal Feeding Operations (CAFOs) but PETA's marketing director said that there was no way PETA would support any operation that "profited from eating animal flesh." Ok, whatever. I was naive, I thought they actually wanted to put an end animal cruelty.

I am in no way, shape, or form a "friend" of PETA, in fact, I created the antithesis group MEETA (Meat-Eaters for the Ethical Treatment of Animals) because of my absolute disdain for that organization. Paying lip service to saving the planet while turning their backs on family farmers seems stupid to me.

But there is one thing that I do like about PETA, and it's their videos. I watch them more often than I really should, because they make me sick to my stomach. Obviously I wouldn't want people to be deterred from eating meat... so why the hell would I want people to watch that horrific crap? Well, thats simply it-- it's horrific. I want you to know what shitty, corn-fed, CAFO meat looks like, and PETA's "Meat Your Meat" series are a disgusting, but accurate display of the Factory Farming industry. That way you can reevaluate how "appetizing" those CAFO animals are. They are sick, and they are making you sick. I'll get to that momentarily. Family Farms FTW.

I can't watch a PETA video without crying, nor can I pass a CAFO without crying. And if I didn't have what it took to stomach the PETA videos, then I would have no business eating animals that were raised in that manner, now would I? If I couldn't stomach the videos, turning a blind eye to the practices of these CAFOs and then "voting" for their proliferation with my hard-earned dollars seems senseless and callous to me. If that's all you have access to, that sucks and it's not your fault--I still feel that you should watch, so at least you feel more compulsion to seek out local, small-scaled farmers.

Part 1 Sequence

So PETA hates Paleo People. So what, I hate them back. Not for being anti-CAFO, that's a plus. No, I hate them for failing to see the bigger picture, because Vegetarianism doesn't prevent animal cruelty.

Like most vegetarian or vegan factions, PETA tells an incomplete story. See, PETA thinks they are preventing animal cruelty by not consuming meat and other animal products, but Vegans and Vegetarians actually *foster* animal cruelty. "How can being a Vegetarian enforce animal cruelty? That's just stupid." Counterintuitive, maybe. Stupid, definitely not. Let's reevaluate their assertion that PETA provides "Everything you need to eat right for your health, for animals, and for the Earth."

Think about it.
Can you imagine how much big agribusiness loves Vegetarians? How could they not? Think of how much money Vegetarians make for the grain industry...why do you think PETA bought stock in Kraft Foods, Inc.?

There are some blatant ways that the Vegetarian role passively fosters animal cruelty, and some more obscure ways too.

To not eat meat is to simply play a passive role in the bigger picture of animal cruelty, with the biggest offenders being the CAFOs. For instance, if a Vegetarian doesn't buy meat and buys faux-meat instead, that means that their dollars are not "voting" for sustainable faming operations that raise ethically treated animals. The way to get CAFO animals off the market is by providing an economic incentive for ethical farmers to flourish.
Vegetarianism as a discipline will not promote animal welfare on smaller-scaled operations. Vegetarianism as a discipline will not reduce others' CAFO meat consumption. When consumers demand higher quality of life and ethically raised market animals with species-appropriate diets, CAFOs will become a nasty memory of agriculture past. But the only way to do this is to bring everyone back to the table taking an active role in supporting our family farmers, *including* the Vegetarians.

So, in essence, their dollars aren't going to CAFOs, but they aren't going to good farmers either. Instead they are going to monocultures like corn, soy, wheat, rice, beans, and quinoa to get their suggested 46 grams of daily protein, which may sound benign and cruelty-free. Unfortunately, most Vegetarians are completely ignorant of the animal suffering that is caused by the monocultures they are reliant on.

According to Mike Archer AM, a Live Systems Research professor at the University of New South Wales, producing wheat and other grains results in at least 25 times more sentient animals are killed per kilogram of useable protein. Woah, how does that make sense?

Part 1 Sequence

Apparently everyone managed to forget that there are small animals living in the fields where crops are planted and ploughed with large tractors. When a farmer ploughs his monoculture crop field, avian scavengers follow them intently, and they aren't circling above looking for dead plants. These birds follow the plough looking for small mammals that were killed so a Vegetarian could sit on their high horse and smugly eat their 'ethical' whole wheat bran muffins, breathing hateful words to the people dining on a grass-fed steak.

Time for a reality check.

Vegetarians can only be so smug as long as they aren't aware of the millions of mice that are poisoned in grain storage facilities every year, or that the best-researched loss of sentient animals is the poisoning of mice for during grain production. Poisoning them leads to a slow and painful death, it's not quick like that of even the most heinous methods of a slaughtering cows. At least 100 mice are killed per hectare to grow a monoculture of grains. This isn't even taking to account the countless insects, spiders, and snakes that are also caught in the crossfire of our inability to deal with eating meat, or our inability to recognize that monocultures are the bane of our existence. If you pride yourself on promoting animal welfare, you had better not be eating a bagel.

Now, If you're a Vegetarian reading this (which is admittedly unlikely) and you're having a hard time giving a shit about mice, let me tell you a little bit about them. Mice sing complex love songs to each other, and baby mice sing a "crying song" to get their mothers to return to the nest. When a female mouse is killed from the poisons being administered to preserve the grains, there's a nest of maybe 4 or 5 babies that are singing their little hearts out for mama mouse to come back, but to no avail. Tearjerking, am I right? They will most likely die of starvation. If they are lucky, maybe they will die an instant death from predation. This happens to millions of mice and their young. We mass-slaughter those *sentient* animals with poison. I'd rather be a pasture-raised market cow than a monoculture mouse any day.

Michael Kirby, Former Justice of the High Court in Australia wrote that "In our shared sentience, human beings are intimately connected with other animals. Endowed with reason and speech, we are uniquely empowered to make ethical decisions and to unite for social change on behalf of others that have no voice. Exploited animals cannot protest about their treatment or demand a better life. They are entirely at our mercy."

He's totally right. If animal welfare is your thing, then this should speak to you. Kirby also said that "Every decision of animal welfare, whether in Parliament or the supermarket, presents us with a profound test of moral character." The question is, are Vegetarians making the right decision to play a passive role in animal welfare, or do the mice need to sing them a love song before they bother giving a shit about them, too?

What else threatens animals on a monoculture are the intensive inputs on a monoculture crop farm like the petroleum-based fertilizers and pesticides. As much as those inputs harm us, imagine the harm they do to the wildlife in the area. Something to

think about. So much for the so-called “benevolent” Vegetarian staples, huh? They aren’t nearly as benevolent as we are led to believe.

Don’t tell PETA that eating bagels promotes animal cruelty, they might just tell people to stop eating altogether or put a bullet in their head. They’re kind of extreme like that. Maybe PETA should take some cues from MEETA and give it a rest. So if the argument from the Vegetarian faction is that we should have a Vegetarian planet for “ethical” reasons, it doesn’t hold water. If everyone was vegetarian, we would have to rely on monocultures to produce our daily protein requirements and from an ethical standpoint, that’s a terrible idea.

Speaking of animal abuse... what about the children of vegetarians? How many nutrient deficiencies are popping up as a result of the “ethical discipline” or is the life of a cow more important than the life of a child? When it came down to me or the cow, the cow had to go. Simple as that.

Just because I want to bust some balls... boycotting meat is also stupid because vegetarians use animal products on a daily basis. There are animal products from the shampoo in your bathroom to the gelatinous membrane that allows your cell phone to vibrate. So, vegetarians, in order to avoid being a complete hypocrite make sure you don’t fly in airplanes, put your phone on vibrate, or let your kids use crayons. Oh, and asshole, are you drinking red wine? Good. Because to clarify that wine, you need egg whites, casein derived from milk, gelatin from animal bones, or isinglass which comes from the bladder of a fish. Ha! You lose.

Coffee Shop Birds

Now I have to tell you, I spend an inordinate amount of time at coffee shops where they sell pastries and baked goods, and have noticed that there always seem to be a lot of birds there with me. I frequently find that owners and patrons alike are incredibly annoyed with the pesky pigeons and finches flocking to the tables en mass, boldly stealing food off the tables or literally out of people’s hands. They are at their feet, hell, there are birds everywhere, but listening to people complain about the “bird problem” makes me laugh out loud. I’ve got a plan, idiots, stop buying and selling bird food and poof your bird problem is solved. Duh.

Being aggravated by the birds at these coffee shops says a lot about how out of touch we are from our Hunter Gatherer past, and how much we really don’t get what’s going on. We are eating bird food, complaining of birds and gastrointestinal problems. Hilarious.

Part 1 Sequence

VEGETARIANISM IS NOT HEALTHY FOR PEOPLE

Dear Vegangelicals,
Slow your role.
Love,
Karen.

Fuck what ya heard, Vegetarianism isn't healthy and it's not going to save the planet. I don't give a shit what Colin T. Campbell said. Sorry I have to do this since usually I leave these people alone, but there is a lot of Vegetarian and Vegan propaganda out there that is being hailed as the answer to agricultural sustainability-- and to be honest it scares me how disillusioned people are about the claimed "benefits" of the vegetarian discipline. So in order to make the argument that agricultural sustainability in a Vegan or Vegetarian world would be a nightmare, I have to first tackle the idea that Vegetarianism is even healthy in the first place.

Without further ado, Let's get down to business... and by business I mean *business*. Let me just say that not only is sex healthy-- it's more fun than Angry Birds and that's saying something.

But what does sex have to do with Vegetarianism? Everything.

Let's get a little history lesson to put things into perspective. The American Vegetarian Society was founded in 1850 by a guy named Sylvester Graham who invented an unsifted flour bread and died the following year in 1851. But here's something interesting that everyone and their mother should know about Graham, he preached that a meat-based diet was unhealthy because it stimulated *excessive sexual desire* which "irritated the body and caused disease." Yes, the guy was anti-getting down with the get down. So, to combat his own sexual desire, he ate a Vegetarian diet. Yeah, that sounds about right. Hence my self-imposed rule of never giving it up for a vegan or a vegetarian...sex is too important a thing in a relationship. I'd be mad if my sexual partner had to take a break to eat a rice cake.

Then there's John Harvey Kellogg, another nutjob. Kellogg preached the benefits of a high-fiber vegetarian diet to combat those demonic "natural urges" and constipation. That makes sense, there's nothing sexy about diarrhea. This guy also invented corn flakes, and advocated abstinence even in a marriage. Holy sexual suppression, Batman. I feel bad for that guy's wife!

Forgive me for this Dr. Phil moment, but if you aren't getting laid and your partner or spouse is vegetarian, you might want to start talking them into a meat-based diet and get the grains out of the pantry. Alternatively, you could just look for someone who is already Paleo if you're looking for a partner that comes standard with a heightened sex

drive... seriously. Google a list of aphrodisiac foods and you will find that they are all Paleo. Tofu is **not** an aphrodisiac, oysters are. Meat wins in the bedroom. Ha! Get it?

A Good Reason to Go Vegetarian.

According to Peter Salonius, in order to live sustainably, the world will have to decrease it's population and go back to living on the resources that local ecosystems produced. Think about it, the human population has gotten out of control. And no, I wouldn't touch the subject of population control with a 15 foot pole. How am I supposed to tell people to stop having sex? I'd be such a hypocrite. You want to quell those desires and off yourself? Go Vegetarian.

What about Heart disease?
Now I'm no Denise Minger, but I know a little something about those false claims that suggest that a plant-based diet is healthier than a diet containing animal-based foods, as suggested in Colin Campbell's *China Study*.

The one argument I hear over and over again is that saturated fats cause cardiovascular disease. For the love of all things pure and good, this has to stop. While it is true that cardiovascular disease is the number one killer in the United States and that most produce contains neither fat nor cholesterol, The International Atherosclerosis Project found that vegetarians have as much atherosclerosis as meat eaters... so obviously there's something amiss here.

As far as saturated fats go, avocados and coconut oils are also chalked full of saturated fats, and there is no question that they are healthy-- even vegetarians would agree. But what the hell is up with that "artery-cloggin' saturated fat", anyway? Is it as evil as the media makes it out to be? And since *when* did we trust the media to give good information?

Let's all get this part straight. Saturated fats are "saturated" because "all available carbon bonds are tied up with a hydrogen atom." Furthermore, this means that "there are no openings for rancidity or spoilage, whereas a polyunsaturated fatty acid containing two or more pairs of double bonds without hydrogen atoms occupying the open space is wide open for oxidation." So in short, saturated fat is heat stable--their molecular structure is not easily altered during cooking. That's a *good* thing.

There's tons of evidence that refutes the idea that cholesterol levels and consumption of saturated fat have anything thing to do with the current state of heart disease in this country, but it's a nice theory especially when the market's modus operandi is to peddle pro-inflammatory vegetable oil consumption instead of animal fats. Follow the money here. Besides, data collected by researchers at Cornell University found that there was "no strong correlation, either negative or positive, with meat eating and any disease." But somehow, Campbell is claiming that these findings suggest "that a diet high in

animal products produces disease and a diet high in grains, vegetables, and other plant matter produces health." Really? Tell that to someone in Bhutan.

I have a theory, maybe Campbell a sexually suppressed nutjob himself like his predecessors. Hey Colin T. Campbell, go eat some oysters.

There was a recent study was published in Nutrition "To explain why vegetarian subjects develop morbidity and mortality from cardiovascular diseases unrelated to vitamin B status" and found that "The low dietary intake of protein and sulfur amino acids by a plant-eating population leads to subclinical protein malnutrition, explaining the origin of hyperhomocysteinemia and the increased vulnerability of these vegetarian subjects to cardiovascular diseases." So, put that in your soy-protein isolate shake and drink it. Your vegetarian diet isn't doing you any good.

How about fiber and cancer, vegetarian's diets are supposed to protect against cancer right? Wrong, of course. "Dietary fiber intake seemed to protect against esophageal cancer, but was positively correlated with higher levels of TB, neurological disorders and nasal cancer. Fiber intake did not confer any significant protection against heart disease or most cancers, including cancer of the bowel." Well, shit.

Speaking of cancer, being a vegetarian doesn't help you either. According to a study found in the American Journal of Clinical Nutrition, vegetarians experience some types of cancer at a much higher rate than the general population, like Hodgkins disease, brain cancers, cervical cancer, and ovarian cancer." According to the researchers at the Cancer Research UK Epidemiology unit, "Studies of cancer have not shown clear differences in cancer rates between vegetarians and non vegetarians."

Honestly, you can find evidence to support anything you want, really. And yes, I'll be touching on that shortly. Oh, and you will love it.

Some say that being a vegetarian and eating a diet devoid of animal products is good for women who are going through the hormonal changes of menopause because grains and legumes have phytoestrogens that are believed to "balance fluctuating hormones" that combat mood swings, weight gain, depression, diminished sex drive, yadda yadda yadda.

Oh, you guys crack me up. It's comical to me that hormones in meat and milk are vilified by the Vegetarian community but hormones in grains and legumes are somehow OK? Wow, people. WOW. News Flash: not getting adequate Vitamin D and B12 will negatively affect natural hormone production and regulation. Key word, *natural.*

If you have ever read the Paleo Solution by Robb Wolf, much of this will be a refresher for you. You see, in order to deter people from eating grains or relying on grains they have to know a little bit more about it in terms of their own health, or waistline. Seriously, whatever it takes to get people to stop eating grains, I'll do it. If I was unable to convince

you before that eating grains was unethical, and a slap in the face of biodiversity--maybe I can convince you that they an insidious health threat and that they are killing you slowly.

I'll start with wheat.

Grains and Health, a visit from Dr. Elke Nelson

PAGING DR. NELSON

Aside from being monocultured crops, Grains suck. Step away from that bagel, or you may end up getting hurt. Not by me, but by the bagel.

First, the wheat that we consume an average of 55 pounds a year of is a product of genetic manipulation and hybridization which rendered a plant that has much higher amounts of starch and gluten, and "many more chromosomes coding for all sorts of new odd proteins." Apparently the moron who engineered modern wheat won a Nobel Prize as it "promised to feed millions of starving around the world." Yeah it's feeding millions of people around the world. It's also making them incredibly sick. Fail.

Oh, and you're not doing yourself a favor either by eating whole wheat instead of white, either in case that's what you're thinking. It's a joke. Those wholesome, "whole grains" are just as processed as the stuff that doesn't have the whole grain. I love it when I hear people talking about how they have done so well cutting out processed crap from their diets, yet they still feel proud of their inclusion of "whole grain breads and pastas" You see, there is no such thing as a whole-wheat bread or pasta tree. Bread is processed. Pastas are processed. Get a friggin' clue, people.

Aaaaand it causes disease. In Type II Diabetes, both white and whole grain bread raise blood sugar levels 70 to 120 mg/dl over starting levels. This spells disaster. High glycemic index foods trigger inflammation, trigger the storage of body fat, and can cause non-alcoholic fatty liver disease. This perpetuates obesity, diabetes, and heart disease. So, I'll throw in an economic incentive not to eat that shit if you want that too.. 1 in 3 dollars of our Medicare costs go to Diabetes care.

An awesome fellow Paleo lady and friend of mine who is a nutritionist, Amy Kubal, sent me this lovely article out of *Nutrition* entitled "Vegetarianism produces subclinical malnutrition, hyperhomocysteinemia, and atherogenesis." The title of the study should tell you all you need to know, vegetarians are diseased as well, unable to escape heart disease like they thought they were going to by adopting a vegetarian diet. You'd have thought that a bunch of paleo researchers had done this work, but they hadn't! Again, someone needs to tell that Colin T. Campbell guy to slow his role. There's "scientific evidence" that supports both sides of this argument.

But I'll tell you one thing Vegetarians, your ancestors are turning in their graves. They coined the word Vegetarian. It's an ancient caveman word for "Piss Poor Hunter."

Part 1 Sequence

Speaking of Ancestors, if you a Vegetarian for health reasons or believe that it makes everything more peaceful, and believe that eating meat is the root cause of all modern disease and destruction, we need a brief history lesson.

HUNTER GATHERERS WERE NOT VEGETARIANS

You may be under the impression that the world is more peaceful and more equal than it has ever been in the history of mankind, but I must say that this notion utter bullshit, especially when you examine the lives of our hunter-gatherer ancestors. Our hunter-gatherer ancestors shared food, weaponry, and worked harmoniously for the greater good of their families and small communities, subsisting on systems of egalitarian values and cultural traditions. There are 85 or so hunter-gatherer tribes still in existence today operate this way. This type of “socialist” behavior was sine qua non for the evolution of human beings. Not saying I’m a socialist, I’m just saying.

It was the advent of agriculture allowed for a system that fostered wealth and poverty, the beginnings of financial inequality and class systems. With wealth and poverty a community is broken into the “Haves” and “Have-nots.” Naturally, the “Haves” of the group had more opportunities, more security, more money, and more political power to further their own agendas and that’s how human culture evolved with the advent of agriculture. Trust me, big agribusiness has lots of money, and flexes that political muscle often-- just look at the bottom rung of the FDA food pyramid. I’ll explain that load of shit in further detail soon.

A sustainable and omnivorous planet is better than the Vegetarian alternative, and our deeply-rooted omnivorous history tends to be largely ignored by Vegetarians who author books on the subject of sustainable agriculture. Ethics aside, history reveals that when we began to rely on plant foods for our source of caloric intake, it was a detriment to not only our health but to that of the planet as well. Because this doesn’t help the Vegetarian faction it is largely ignored or blatantly omitted. I won’t omit that part. In fact, I *plan* on “bogging” this book down with “science,” along with my omnivorous viewpoint.

So let’s look at life before the Vegetarian discipline, before the advent of agriculture: let’s delve into the history of our Hunter-Gatherer ancestors. (Yes, your ancestors ate meat.)

The Paleolithic era was a period of human history that is characterized by the development of primitive tools, it represents roughly 99% of human technological history. Human beings hunted and gathered, getting their food from wild plants and wild animals. Then we transitioned into agricultural societies which relied heavily on domesticated species of plants and animals. The Neolithic Era is considered the last part of the Stone Age, the rise of of farming. There are few hunter-gatherer societies left in the world that still hunt wild animals and gather wild plants. What’s amazing is that these people are freakishly healthy, a stark contrast to our current state of affairs. The question is, why are they so damn healthy?

Simply put, they eat a species-appropriate diet. They are on what we Westerners would call a Paleo Diet, and in order to be healthy like them we have to start with eating like them.

Because we are omnivores (argue all you want, I'll win) we must ensure that a sustainable plan for the future includes proper nutrition for the benefit of our species and the benefit of our progeny, to the benefit of the earth that we depend on. What's amazing is that when our own health becomes the center of importance, so follows the health of the planet, and sustainability becomes inevitable. This is perhaps the boldest statement that I can make, and the basic and defining premise of this book. Yes, you heard me correctly. Care more about yourself and your own health and the health of the world will follow. Conservationists want you to be less selfish and more giving, I am suggesting that you become more selfish, caring more about your health and your pocketbook. That's how I roll. I am an anthropocentric bitch, which I will explain in painful detail later.

There was an exact point in time when humans started screwing over the planet, and it didn't happen when we started building cars. No, that happened the day we started relying on agriculture for our subsistence, the so-called Agricultural Revolution of the Neolithic Era. Before that, the last moment when everything was fine was in the Paleolithic Era. You see, it's appropriate that we recognize that fact when we look into the notion of sustainability. If till agriculture was the beginning of ruin, it makes no sense to me to further advocate till agriculture or monocultures in general. If we knew that our Paleolithic ancestors, who hunted and gathered *and* ate meat lived in an era of true sustainability, then that's where we should be getting our cues from.

I think it's appropriate that we begin to look into this notion of sustainability by delving into the lives of our omnivorous, hunter-gatherer ancestors to pinpoint the exact moment where we went wrong and how Paleolithic principles can help us make smarter decisions in the future, because we sure as hell are screwing things up right now. We should NOT be taking our cues from Vegetarians. Why?

According to Canadian soil microbiologist Peter Salonius, the moment we screwed everything up was the moment we abandoned our bows and arrows and took up agriculture. You see, we stepped out of our roles, and the soil began to suffer. The "soil needs tightly woven natural ecosystems to properly recycle nutrients and prevent soil erosion." But we have been cleverly devising new systems to increase our food production that has caused soil erosion and a loss in fertility, but it did increase the human population greatly. What do Vegetarians rely on for caloric intake? Agriculture.

Humans were hunter-gatherers and if you cannot accept this as a factual statement--then this is going to be a very difficult book to read because its going to serve as the frame of reference for many future arguments in this book. It's going to be hard if you think that the world is only 6,000 years old. You must also accept that animals weren't

always domesticated and that they used to live successfully in the wild without the helping hand (or forcible hand) of humans-- this will also serve as a frame of reference for other future arguments so if you are willing to accept both of those statements as factual, then you won't think that this book or the ideas in this book are a total load of crap.

Still reading? Great. The Human species existed as hunter-gatherers for approximately 2.5 million years, and 10,000 years ago adopted agriculture. Though there is much controversy surrounding the particular reason that we adopted agriculture and domesticated animals, it is more important to understand why in so many ways this was a huge mistake for the health of the human species, the environment, the water, the soil, biodiversity, and the planet in general. If we took a poll for biggest mistake in human history, I'd vote for the advent of agriculture.

For the most part, as a species we have made a lot of progress, but the advent of agriculture was definitely a step in the wrong direction in terms of our general health and the health of our planet. Even though we enjoy the luxuries in life which were never afforded to cavemen-- cars, medicine, energy from petroleum, Dora The Explorer-- we are still not the picture of health as our early human ancestors were. If you just read that last sentence and thought it was silly because everyone knows that humans lived unhealthy, short lives and died at 30 years of age, here is what I have to say to you:

You are not an archaeologist you are a heart surgeon. The agricultural revolution did not save the human species from misery, obviously, because you are still on national television. I am, however, flattered that you're reading my book though Dr. Oz.

The most common counterargument against the hunter-gatherer lifestyle is that people died at 30 on average, but this number is terribly misleading because it gives no insight into the lives, and actual lifespan of our hunter-gatherer ancestors. For the sake of argument, let's refresh our memories on what the word average means:

The result obtained by adding several quantities together and then dividing this total by the number of quantities; the mean.

Now for argument's sake I'll ask you to take a couple that both lived to be 70 years of age that had 2 offspring that died at birth.

70+70+0+0 = 140
140/4 = 35

The average number for this particular equation is 35. This small family had an average lifespan of 35 because their children died at birth, which was an incredibly common occurrence. This means that they experienced a lower-than-average lifespan of people today, but they lived to 70 years of age without the aid of antibiotics, hospitals, surgeons, medicare, and bandaids. Using the average number as an argument is

misleading, and is only useful when trying to discredit the concept of living and eating like a hunter-gatherer. Before the advent of agriculture, the leading causes of death were infection, accidents, blunt trauma, murder, etc. But most importantly, our ancestors weren't suffering from the degenerative diseases that we see today, such as heart disease, hypertension, hypercholesterolemia, diabetes, obesity, and a huge list of other chronic diseases. A better indicator would be gathering information from a life table, that charts the living population by age group-- but that doesn't make for good t.v., and nobody wants their corporate sponsorship taken away, do they? I hope you find the "average-age" counterargument against the vitality of hunter-gatherers as valid as a the claim that Dr. Melina Jampolis knows anything about nutrition-- just look at her "nutrition" bars.

FITNESS OF A SPECIES, JUST MAKE BABIES

This is not to say that in many ways we didn't benefit from the adoption of agriculture, because we did. According to Darwin, the 'fitness' of a species is measured only by the number of offspring that an individual has, as long as the offspring is able to contribute to future generations. So by Darwin's assessment, I'd say that the human species is quite 'fit,' as demonstrated by the skyrocketing number of people on this planet that shows no sign of retreat or even plateauing.

In fact, sedentism and the adoption of agriculture supported a higher population and birthrate since it allowed people more time to have sex. So as the 'fitness' of the human species improved with the advent of agriculture, other plant species also benefited, like corn, wheat, and soy. Through generations and generations of seed selection, these plant species became hardy and even co-evolved with humans. In areas before where these plants would not grow--such as in forests and swamps, humans have made way for them by clear-cutting forests and drying up fertile swamps to plant them. In fact, the corn that is so abundant today could not propagate without the help of humans pulling open the husks. I'd say that these plants have the human species completely whipped, so to speak.

Even the domesticated animals improved the fitness of their species. Cows, chickens, and other domesticated animals if you can believe it also improved the 'fitness' of their species. I imagine though, that if the ghosts of aurochs, wild boar, and red junglefowl past saw the living conditions of their progeny today, they never would have bargained with humans for this type of mistreatment and malnutrition for their kind in the first place. But then again, the 'fitness' of a species only cares that they procreate, so in that light they have been successful. Like humans, the 'fitness' of those animal species also had a cost associated with their domestication, and their cost, like ours, was general health. But that is something I will harp on ad nauseum later.

Take note, however, that nowhere in the definition of 'fitness' does it mention or indicate that there is one iota of importance placed on how diseased an individual or a species may be postpartum. And by diseased, I mean *diseased*. It doesn't help either that we are completely misled about the health benefits of grains, and warned away from saturated-fats and red meat. We are grainwashed, lipophobes. Great, there's some 7

billion + people on this planet and most of us think that eating grains is healthy, and that sustainable grass-fed beef is unhealthy because of the fat. Have we no common sense here? People, go Paleo if you want to save the planet and yourselves. If you need more reasons to go Paleo, read on.

THE AGRICULTURAL REVOLUTION WASN'T HEALTHY FOR THE PLANET

Every time you watch the Superbowl and hear *America the Beautiful* sung by the most popular musician of the year, you are unconsciously led to believe that amber waves of grain are something pure. If you've ever read Malcolm Gladwell's "*Blink*," you'll understand this as being "primed." Even though I know Katharine Lee Bates wrote the song, I still wonder deep down inside whether or not it was actually written by Cargill, Nabisco, Kraft, or Monsanto-- maybe even the USDA. It's kind of their schtick to turn something toxic, dangerous, and unsustainable into something we collectively think of as wholesome.

When they say amber waves of grain, seas of grain, mountains of grain, they mean it. We've got LOTS of cereal grains. Wheat, corn, rice, barley, oats, spelt.. you name it, we produce an inordinate amount of it. We also select a single species to focus our mass production on, and we like it because it has a higher yield AND it's magnificently tolerant to all of the crap we do to it; like spraying tons of chemicals on them.

Cereal crops are annuals. Wheat is an annual, corn is an annual, most commercially grown legumes are annuals (though they are nitrogen fixing, and that's a bonus) that means that the already nutrient-depleted soil has to be tilled every year, and it has to be augmented with petroleum-based fertilizer. And if it's not petroleum-based fertilizer, it's CAFO pig, cow, or chicken-shit, which I'll get into later. Even though perennials are cool and we don't have to do a lot of upkeep, they don't produce as much so that doesn't help us make our bottom line. Again, it's about money. Bummer!

Our farming techniques are so far beyond traditional Mom & Pop farming that we are producing massive amounts of resistant crops, and by resistant I mean *resistant.* These crops are disease-resistant, herbicide-resistant, pesticide-resistant, and even drought-resistant, and man do they sound like a god-send. But this entire system is absolutely, without a doubt, as unsustainable as it gets. Besides, those systems are becoming less and less effective, and thus we have to do more and more shit to them for upkeep.

We have devised technologies that have defied the rules of mother nature, and we are morons if we think we are winning. We *desperately* need a lesson in history.

I'll start with Greece.

Part 1 Sequence

SOIL EROSION

Greece has been plagued with “episodes of deforestation and soil erosion” for the better part of 8,000 years according to Fatal Harvest, a book that anyone who cares deeply about agricultural sustainability should check out. The Greeks relied on their gods and goddesses for guidance in their agricultural endeavors and unfortunately for them, they were looking in the wrong place for help as evidenced by the fact that archaeological discoveries indicate that their agricultural practices ruined their topsoil, and they had to move because the land could no longer produce food. Land degradation and loss of fertility is no joke.
Mother Nature: 1, Greeks: 0.

So, how about the Romans? Surely they fared better? ‘Fraid not. Just like the Greeks, the Romans screwed up agriculturally as they also experienced land degradation, loss of topsoil and fertility. Instead of placing their faith in the natural systems that mother nature created, they placed their faith in their fellow human beings-- believing that human ingenuity could outsmart the laws of mother nature. And of course they experienced massive soil erosion just like the Greeks and had to move to a more fertile area because they were starving.
Mother Nature: 2, Romans 0.

How about in the Americas? I hope you have picked up on the trend so far, the inability to mitigate land degradation and infertility does not end well, no matter how pretty the climate or local geography may be. The Mexican Highlands fared no better, and experienced what Fatal Harvest refers to as “devastating soil erosion.” Researchers from the University of Sheffield in Britain discovered through radiocarbon dating that there were three distinct periods of soil erosion, the first coincides with when the Highlands Indians first began cultivating corn approximately 3,500 years ago, the second occurred on the slopes of cultivated hills, and the third and most recent loss of soil fertility and erosion coincides with deforestation. Hmmm.. deforestation is a problem? Yes, yes it is. I’ll get to that.

The decline of Teotihuacán has been linked to droughts and climate changes, and this is supported by archaeological findings of “juvenile skeletons with evidence of malnutrition.” People starved as crops failed, and sacrifices had to be made. Usually that involved decapitated humans with their heads rolling down the steps of a pyramid.

Silly Teotihuacán rulers, how did that work for you? Ha. I know this is belated, but they totally should have gone Paleo.
Mother Nature: 3, Mexicans 0.

What about today? Are we doing any better? Surely we are... I mean, we are so damn civilized and technologically advanced. We drink Starbucks coffee and eat blueberry scones, and check our email on our iPhones. We’ve got this mother nature b*tch whipped, don’t we?

Not at all.

Arable land is land that can be used for growing crops, and we have increased the soil erosion THREE-FOLD since prehistoric times. Soil erosion, loss of fertility, and other forms of land degradation now rob the world of 140 or so square kilometers of farming land a year. Worldwide, soil erosion has caused the abandonment of 4.3 million square kilometers in the last 40 years. Perspective: we are losing 100 billion tons of topsoil every year-- 5 times faster than nature can create it. Ummm, that sounds pretty effin unsustainable to me. According to Bruce Sundquist, the total world availability of topsoil is estimated at 7,000 gig tons, so we have an estimated 70 years left of topsoil.

Just a little case in point, let's look at Kansas.

Organic matter content of 10 sites in western Kansas declined by an average of 19% between 1948 and 1984. "Organic matter levels are now 50-60% of original levels in prairie soils." Holy crap what happened? Well, what does Kansas produce, exactly? Oh, wheat. Amber waves of grain. The raw material of your stupid whole wheat bagel. Yeah, your bagel has led to a loss of organic matter and therefore degraded the soil that we are dependent on for food. That's today, with our plasma TVs and Man on the Moon awesomeness. We still haven't got that mother nature b*tch whipped. Not at all.

Besides cereal grains being heavily dependent on fossil fuels, the nutritionally-void soil has to be tilled, new seeds have to be planted. Perennials don't need all of that crap, and don't need to be tilled and replanted with each new season. They have more standing biomass, and have deeper roots which means better erosion control, less long-term requirements for fertilization and irrigation, but they don't produce as much as their annual counterparts so they aren't as profitable. Even though the common-sense approach to agriculture and sustainability would include their propagation, we like profitability more. Don't act surprised there, reader.

Population: According to the FAO, the population of developing countries is "projected to increase by about 2 percent per year" and is said "to account for about 90 percent of the expected increase in global population." The FAO suggests that the growth rate of the human population over the next 40 years or so will require a 40-50 percent increase in agricultural production in order to "maintain the present level of food intake." Crap. But if we are ruining the land, while increasing our need for more food under unsustainable practices, we are going to have some problems. Heads will roll. Teotihuacan style, too, I bet.

Want to put that human ingenuity to use? Either we need to find another planet to live on, or we seriously need to pull our heads out of our asses and give up this moronic idea that our current agricultural systems are our last hope of feeding the world population. If you want to be an ethically-motivated consumer, or an environmentally-conscious consumer, I suggest not eating anything that is depleting the soil of nutrients. I suggest not eating resource-intensive grains. I suggest not eating anything from a monoculture.

Unfortunately, if you're a Vegan or Vegetarian you might die following this rule. Where are you going to get your protein from in an actually sustainable environment that isn't ruining the soil? Alternatively, you can just admit defeat, sterilize yourself, and drink suicide Kool-Aid. When it's my life or that of a cow's, the cow is going to die, but that's just me. I'd rather just go Paleo.

Mother Nature: This is too big of a number to write on this page
Humans: 0

GRAINWASHING AND LIPOPHOBIA

Before we continue, I'd like you to ask yourself an important question. How much do you trust your government on a scale of 1-10? Now, write that answer down somewhere.

Wise words from a dead President
"Government by Organized Money is Just as Dangerous as Government by Organized Mob" Franklin D. Roosevelt. Frankie D., you were one smart cookie.

Part 1 Sequence

Back up, Karen. How come we don't know any of this about our food? What about the Food Pyramid? Well, biased reporting of science for industry-supported research is a common practice, and it's scary. There's a book called Bending Science: How Special Interests Corrupt Public Health Research written by Thomas O. McGarity and Wendy Wagner that I think everyone and their mother should read. In this book, they detail the "sophisticated legal and financial tactics political and corporate advocates use to discredit or suppress research on potential human health hazards." What about scientific integrity and public safety? Well, that goes out the window when we "bend" science and routinely strong-arm scientists into submission by blocking their research and threatening "financial ruin." The science which we rely on so heavily is corrupt. Shit.

Bending Science discusses methods and motivations for bending science, as well as a step-by-step plan for manipulating science to support a predetermined conclusion and not get caught. But it all starts with an entity with a financial or political interest in manipulating science with deep pockets. If you've got the money, you can pretty much get the "science" to reach whatever conclusion you want. No surprise there.

Then these entities use PR firms and journalists to advertise and disseminate the "bent" science to the public. They do this for a few reasons actually; to weaken the regulation of a product, to defend themselves during a litigation, or to promote the benefits of a product. So, if you have money, you can disseminate "bent" science and change public opinion about whatever. Even Grains. Even Fat. Even Meat. *Bending Science* should be on your bedside table, unless realizing how corrupt the whole system is will keep you up at night.

My best advice when you are trying to sift through all the bullshit information about health and diet is to follow the money. Understanding the fraudulent practices of those entities looking for financial gain can greatly change the way you look at the conventional "wisdoms" and dietary guidelines that are handed down to us by our government.

When science becomes so "bent," and the information disseminated is so bastardized, it's hard to trust anything or anyone. What can you trust? The answer, in short, is yourself and your common sense. How can 2.5 million years of evolution, and the food we subsisted on suddenly become toxic to our health? How the hell did we become a nation of Grainwashed Lipophobes?

Well, the "science" was bastardized and manipulated, and then disseminated through various channels to make us think that way. We have suffered some "serious adverse consequences for human health and the health of the environment, as well as the economic well-being of legitimate businesses." The legit business are suffering while we pander to those that disseminate shitty, corrupt science. Our health suffers. The economy suffers. The planet suffers.

Part 1 Sequence

I am telling you about *Bending Science* because if I can plant the seed and help you connect the dots, then you will be able to see that something is amiss here. Tom Naughton who is best known for his documentary Fat Head said that “our government promotes a diet that is turning us into a nation of fat diabetics in order to assist the grain industry” and that’s what I’m trying to tell you. Our government, that maybe you trust at a 10, is part and parcel to turning us into a nation of fat diabetics in order to *assist an industry.* You’ll come to that conclusion too once you connect the dots. Keep reading.

Our government has also “forced that crappy diet on schools and other government institutions and attempted (often successfully) to stifle researchers who questioned the supposed science behind that diet, using funding as a weapon.” Corrupt science and corrupted policymakers and federal agencies make Grainwashing and Lipophobia possible. It’s about money and politics here, not science.

For my case in point, let’s look at Dr. Kilmer McCulley who was forced out of Harvard for publishing his research that disputed the USDA’s government nutritional policy, specifically their suggestion to reduce fat and cholesterol intake-- and subsequently increase grain intake. Dr. Kilmer was later told that “the powers at Harvard were warned the National Institute of Health (NIH) would cut off their funding if they kept him around.” Publishing good scientific research has turned into more than just doing your job as a scientist, it makes you a dissenter. Dissent against the conventional wisdom can get you kicked out of Harvard. Screw the fact that you’re a scientist doing your job... it’s not personal. It’s political.

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Exactly!



"You are completely free to carry out whatever research you want, so long as you come to these conclusions."

Part 1 Sequence

Back to Grainwashing and Lipophobia, let's take a look into the Dietary Goals for The United States that was produced by the McGovern Senate Select Committee on Nutrition and Human needs in 1977, which is probably one of the biggest reasons that people today are so lipophobic, grainwashed, and red-meat averse. This was the first time our government intervened in our diets and told us what to eat, but the publication of the report had less to do with nutritional science, and more to do with politics.

You see, George Stanley McGovern was a Senator, not a nutritionist. McGovern's Committee was formed in 1968 with the purpose of eradicating hunger and malnutrition in the United States. World Hunger was a hot topic at the time. Initially the committee created food-assistance programs, but by 1977 the committee was in danger of being reorganized and "downgraded into a subcommittee." To circumvent reorganization, the committee had to do something public and important, so they decided to tackle the hot topic of world hunger, and took cues from Frances Moore Lappe. *Sigh*

Frances Moore Lappe (a vegetarian, mind you) wrote a book called Diet For a Small Planet in 1971. The concern that was being addressed in Diet For a Small Planet was world hunger, and rightfully so. She argued that eating a plant-based diet was the best solution to deal with the world hunger issue, and that grain-fed meat production was wasteful and the real culprit in food scarcity because the livestock industry required 20 million tons of grain and soy to produce 2 million tons of beef. Her idea was to just eat the grain and soy, and not waste it on feeding livestock. From an immature viewpoint of world hunger being a misallocation of resources and not a distribution and centralization issue, I could see how that would make sense to her, I guess. That book sold over 3 million copies, so you can see how famine was an important political problem, like I said. Yay, Vegetarian propaganda under the guise of "Saving the world." *Vomit* Because it had become such a hot topic of discussion in the U.S., McGovern's Committee decided to take up arms over the hunger issue and create the Dietary Goals for the United States to secure their own Committee from reorganization. The best way to safeguard a committee from reorganization is to do something the public would care about. That makes sense. But telling us what to eat wasn't exactly done to reduce heart disease in the country as much as it was a political move. Am I sounding like a broken record yet?

By tackling Word Hunger and endorsing the growing lipophobic sentiment with the Dietary Goals for the United States-- you can promote the Senate Select Committee's reputation and McGovern's reputation as a Senator. Brilliant. Politicians just *love* looking good in the public eye.

But the problem with this is that the public was under the impression that the government finally had the answer to heart disease and was sharing it out of the goodness of their own hearts--that was their first mistake. Of course there were scientists who objected... but you know what happens to scientists that start dissenting. It's sort of scary for them, their livelihoods are at stake. If I was a scientist with a mortgage and lived hand-to-mouth, paycheck to paycheck with a family to feed, I

wouldn't say anything either. I applaud those who do, because that takes cojones of steel.

Then there's the American Heart Association who also influences the state of public health with dietary recommendations, you know, the organization that puts their heart-healthy logo on stuff like General Mills' Cocoa Puffs because it's a "healthy" whole grain cereal. Seriously. The AHA is a joke.

Enter Ancel Keys, a board member of the AHA and another jackass who published shoddy science with his Seven Countries Study (stupid, stupid, stupid) which has been time and time again refuted by anyone who looked at the process he used to come to his conclusions. It was not good science by any stretch of the imagination, He was omitting evidence that went against his hypothesis-- which was that dietary fat and cholesterol intake was responsible for heart disease. In 1961 He was given an entire spread in Times Magazine, furthering this low-fat bullshit kick. He was hailed savior of the American people, yet somehow we have seen a significant skyrocket in cardiovascular disease since his recommendations... hmmm..

Nevertheless, he heavily influenced the AHA, which also had an alliance with the vegetable oil and margarine industry. Is it any wonder that they vilify red meat? Fail. Then the AHA distributed handbooks to doctors offices all over the country, touting the heart-healthy benefits of polyunsaturated fats from vegetable oils like corn oil. So the patients who take everything these doctors tell them as gospel began to shift away from red meat, and toward vegetable oils believing that they were healthier. Nevermind the fact that highly inflammatory polyunsaturated vegetables have caused cancer in rats and such. Who cares about that?

So in a way, we have to let doctors off the hook for giving us shitty nutritional advice. You see, the information that our doctors are getting is coming from what are seemingly benign, non-profit organizations like the AHA. Or worse, from the FDA or USDA which is lobbied by none other than big agriculture and the pharmaceutical industry. It's not their fault. They are technicians, not scientists or researchers. They are just doing their job with the best information they had access to, at least this is what I tell myself to keep from going totally postal on the doctors that I saw during that period.

So, everyone is under the impression that when "saturated-fat free" and "low cholesterol" fluff words appear on a packaged product they are nutritionally superior, health foods. The "health food" industry has shifted. Awesome. All the while, there is an organization, a corporation, big-agribusiness, or a politician that is profiting substantially. What do you do when you have a lot of money and an agenda? Well, not only do you get researchers to publish "bent" science, you hire lobbyists.

What a Lobbyist does is provide federal officials with advice and expertise, and that comes often in the form of "bent" science. They also arrange campaign contributions, media events, public demonstrations, bully critics, and encourage lawsuits. Lobbyists have been so good at what they do that sometimes they have been considered to

constitute their own branch of government. They are paid to represent private-- not public-- interests. And a lot of the stuff that they do is behind closed doors, hidden from the public eye.

The entire act of lobbying itself should raise questions about undue influence and total misuse of financial power. Our political system does not weigh the rights of wealthy individuals, corporate interests, or interest groups against the rights of society as a whole. What pisses me off is the ability of food companies to use lobbyists to influence lawmakers and policymakers to act in their favor when it's at the expense of public health. That's not fair.

Just being Honest

Then again, if I had a billion dollars I'd be lobbying too-- just to even things up. Don't be surprised if you find out that I'm schmoozing with some Congressman over grass-fed filet mignon. I'd totally do it if I could. I'm a hypocrite like that I guess.

Lobbying is an old problem, and one that concerned our 4th president James Madison greatly. He warned of the "dangerous vice" of a "faction" and recognized the dire need for a "separation of powers," a governmental system equipped with "auxillary precautions" of checks and balances to prevent the "factious spirit" from causing "instability, injustice, and confusion... into the public councils." Long story short, Madison worried about the influence of lobbyists on lawmakers. He was on to something.

Despite Madison's warnings, that is precisely what happened. There were even congressional efforts to control lobbying, because it was dishonest and even downright abusive, and there was a wide margin open for corruption. So what brilliant answer did Congress come up with? They decided to *regulate* it. They made lobbying legal. That's right, *legal.* All the lobbyists had to do was register and disclose their sources of funding, that's all. Fail.

After Congress regulated it, they didn't enforce any punitive procedures, so to state the obvious; lobbying regulations were completely and utterly unenforceable and *ineffective*. So, what about public interest, then? Well, screw public interest unless they are lining a congressman's pocket. If you've got the money you can sway policy, otherwise you can take up hours and hours of personal time that you don't have to combat those unilaterally beneficial policies. Seems a little unfair? It is. Madison is rolling in his grave.

But why am I harping on lobbyists and policymakers right now? Because in order for you to make any sense of our government nutrition policy, you have to understand the influence of lobbying and how that weighs on political processes and policies. Food corporations and big agribusiness are exerting an influence on the FDA and USDA, as evidenced by our ridiculous "Food Pyramid" or "Food Plate," it's also why GMOs aren't yet labeled, and why CAFO "farming continues.

Part 1 Sequence

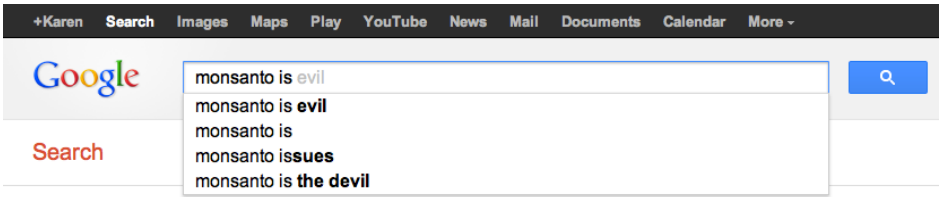
Think about it.
Speaking of pushing to regulate GMOs, I think this is stupid just like I think regulating lobbying is stupid. Some things should be just downright illegal. Should we *regulate* stuff like child pornography? No. It should be outright *illegal.* So if you were the person that collected those 10 million signatures asking simply to regulate GMOs, please rewrite it and ask for an outright ban. I'll sign that. Twice.

A Lobbyist's job is to influence government laws, rules, and policies that will benefit the special-interest groups that pay them, whether or not they are beneficial to anyone else. It's legal to do so. It was regulated.

So what do big, multinational corporations do to establish dominance over our food system? Lots of stuff. They lobby government nutrition policymakers and they tell you to get 6-8 servings of grains a day. They under-price small scale competition, and develop a "revolving door" between themselves and the government agencies that are supposed to be regulating them. Then there's the vertical integration method, where they control everything from financing to seed patents to worldwide distribution and have created farmer dependency on their system, on their terms. They control everything and they make billions. While they make billions, we pay the cost of rising healthcare, environmental pollution, and economic collapse.

"Taking a position in government doesn't cancel the natural human tendency towards greed. It simply gives that greed coercive powers."- Tom Naughton

So, what about Organic label? Afterall, The National Organic Program is run by the USDA... (You knew I was going to get to that, didn't you?) Guess what Organic is... it's a term that is *federally* regulated. What I am saying is that the government that's running this show now, lobbied by lord knows who with intentions of God knows what. In case you missed it, the USDA is pretty sneaky agency known for super-pointless certifications and the mass murder of millions of animals a year, but I'll get to that later. Don't forget that the secretary of the USDA is Tom Vilsack, a Monsanto executive. Yes, I said Monsanto. If you don't know what Monsanto is, Google "Monsanto is" and check out the autofill words Google provides and you'll have the gist of it. Below is a screen capture that I just took to make this point. Please feel free to take a break and do this yourself, perhaps maybe even read an article or 5. That will help you understand the gravity of the fact that Shitsack, er... Vilsack is the Secretary of the USDA.



The National Organic Program is not run by Sir Albert Howard. For one he is dead, and apparently his principles are too. I mean, the guy pretty much hammered the importance of sustainability into everything he touched. Now it is in the hands of the USDA, and they are bending rules left and right to turn a profit, bending over and taking it in the ass for big agribusiness, and they certify operations that are completely and utterly unsustainable. Yuck. If the NOP had espoused sustainability like the Organic Movement intended for it to, I wouldn't have had to write this stupid book. I wouldn't have had to say anything. Buck they suck, so here I am... typing away.

To really evaluate the issue with the NOP being run by the USDA, you have to know a bit about the bigger picture. Corruption isn't just something that happens among elected officials inside of the White House, corruption is something that happens everywhere, and that includes the USDA, and I dare say the *entire* food industry.

Corruption breeds the lack of regard for public health, along with a lack of regard for the environment. These corrupt elected and *appointed* officials are commonplace, signs of a much, much larger problem. It shows that multinational, powerful corporations have infiltrated the systems and are choosing the policymakers, dictating the laws, and are completely in control of the production and distribution of products. They control the rules that everyone plays by. They control your mind, that is, if you're still a grainwashed lipophobe.

Right now, at this very moment, there is a Fox in the USDA Hen House, and the president of the United States of America *put him there.* 'Shitsack' as I like to call him is the former governor of Iowa. Iowa makes a lot of genetically modified corn, and Shitsack is a big supporter of genetically engineered pharmaceutical crops. He was the originator of a seed pre-emption bill that "took away local government's possibility of ever having a regulation on seeds- where [genetically engineered] would be grown, having [genetically engineered]-free buffers, banning pharma corn locally, etc." He's obviously not a guy with our best interests at heart. I mean, the guy travels on Monsanto's private jet... he's a shill for Monsanto. Why is he Secretary of the USDA?

This is a BIG problem. Despite whatever popularized food movements or "Millions against Monsanto" sentiments we see-- Shitsack is still Secretary of the USDA, even though the world hates Monsanto. And he's *not* the only fox in that hen house.

Think about it.
Michael Taylor was the Vice President of Public Policy at Monsanto Corp from 1998-2001 and was a Monsanto *lobbyist.* The guy has seriously moved up in the world, because now he is the Deputy Commissioner at the FDA. He was appointed to this position by the president of the United States of America. Yeah, WTF. Check out the petition at Signon.org, President Obama, I oppose your appointment of Michael Taylor," "Taylor is the same person who was Food Safety Czar at the FDA when genetically modified organisms were allowed into the U.S. food supply without undergoing a single test to determine their safety or risks. This is a travesty." <-- Agreed. Watch the documentary *The World According to Monsanto*, you will see that this guy has been moving between Monsanto and the FDA and USDA for decades.

David Axelrod (Obama's campaign advisor) recently appeared on CNN saying that "As president, [Obama] has ended the revolving door between industry and government." What I want to know is, is that guy on crack? You don't think his appointment of Shitsack to Secretary of the USDA does not *exemplify* the revolving door between the food industry and the government agencies that regulate it? Maybe he thinks we are all idiots. Maybe we are. We didn't devise a system that could protect ourselves from having these big agribusiness shills in these prominent positions. We didn't make lobbying illegal.

Speaking of "revolving doors," I've got to give a big huge hats-off to Dr. Luise Light, Ed.D. No, this time I'm not being facetious. I really do love her. Here's why:

Dr. Light was hired by the USDA to develop a new food guide to replace the "Basic Four" in the 1980s and as an insider, she is able to view a larger picture than I probably ever could. So, what does Dr. Light say about the fundamental problem of our government's nutritional policy? I mean, if anyone is going to have a handle on the situation it's going to be her, an insider with the balls to dissent. She says, "Ultimately, the food industry dictates the government's food advice, shaping the nutrition agenda delivered to the public. In fact, to the food industry, the purpose of food guides is to persuade consumers that all foods (especially those that they're selling) fit into a healthful diet." Damn, Luise. That's heavy.

When the Dietary Guidelines were up for revision in 2005, Dr. Luise Light Ed.D asked whether or not we should "expect something less compromised and more reflective of what Americans need to achieve good health?" Answering her own question she said, "I think not." Why?

> "The Guidelines include meaningless — even deceptive — recommendations like: "Choose carbohydrates wisely for good health" (is a breakfast cereal that's 38 percent sugar a "wise" choice?) and "Choose fats wisely for good health" (are

> fast food French fries cooked in artery-clogging, partially hydrogenated vegetable oil, a powerful promoter of heart disease, a “wise” choice?)”

Amen, Lady. Amen. It made my day reading those words together “*artery-clogging, partially hydrogenated vegetable oil.*” See, I told you I love this lady.

> “These statements, which will form the basis of all national food and nutrition policy (including all of the U.S. school meal programs), protect every interest group in the food industry by basically setting no limits on any type or amount of fat and carbohydrate consumed. And all of this with the directive to “control calorie intake to manage body weight.” Say what?”

Alright, so hopefully you are picking up what Dr. Light is putting down here. “Nutrition for the government is primarily a marketing tool to fuel growth in consumer food expenditures and demand for major food commodities: meat, dairy, eggs, wheat. It’s an economics lesson that has very little to do with our health and nutrition and everything to do with making sure that food expenditures continue to rise for all interests involved in the food industry.” You don’t say.

And what else happens routinely that makes Dr. Light cringe? The relationship the USDA has with the food industry, “whose executives often end up in the USDA leadership positions,” like Shitsack and Tailored, errr.. Vilsack and Taylor. This epitomizes “revolving-doors” between industry and the agencies charged with regulating them-- nice try, Axelrod.

Consumer groups of course find out that these food industry shills are the ones that are on the panel for writing the federal Food Guidelines and request immediate removal. Good luck consumer groups! Not happening, you don’t have the money *or* political sway of food industry lobbyists. According to Dr. Light, agriculture is among the top 10 industries that spend the most on lobbying efforts. Hmmm... still wonder why your kid is eating Sugar Puffs and Pizza for breakfast everyday at school?

Don’t blame Sodexo if that’s where you went. Sodexo’s hands are firmly tied behind its back, they are regulated by the federal government and have to adhere to strict federal guidelines and government nutritional policies. I wanted to hate them at first too, until I talked to an insider that was just as aggravated by the system as I was. It’s not Sodexo. It’s the government. So please, send your hate mail to the appropriate mailbox.

Here’s the point that I want you to leave with: the USDA can’t be relied on to provide objective advice about nutrition with their glaring conflicts-of-interest. Since the initial Food Guide was developed we have seen “an unprecedented nutrition crisis. A majority of Americans have poor-quality diets and the rates of diet-related chronic diseases, from cancer, diabetes and heart disease to digestive diseases and arthritis, are soaring.” Not to mention autoimmune diseases, but that’s for another chapter entirely.

Now ask yourself again, on a scale of 1-10 how much do you trust the government?

I'm as Anthropocentric as they come, and I don't care.

There's a lot of tension in the field of environmental ethics between those that fall under the anthropocentric view of nature-- where the anthropocentric viewpoint advocates that man trumps nature, and the ecocentric view which advocates that man and his creations are artificial and unnatural. Ecocentrics believe that the underlying cause for the current world environmental crisis is because of the anthropocentric ideology of exploitation, which I don't disagree with. We screwed some shit up, royally. We didn't take the rest of the planet into account and we should have, but only because what we screw over will turn right back around and bite us in the ass and that's a fact. It makes me think karma may be a real thing.

My viewpoint is that humans "trump" nature, but it's perfectly natural. We have human impulses, and got this magnificently large brain which allowed us to adapt to some particularly hairy situations with some human ingenuity. That was all a consequence of our evolution as a species: i.e. natural. Has our human ingenuity, and perhaps our disillusioned idea that we were so ingenious that we could trump the laws of nature gotten us into a world of trouble? Yes, absolutely. We're smart, but we can't outsmart natural systems and ecosystems and still survive. Our big brains and desire to exploit every natural resource available has screwed us over. Nature won, we lost. Does it matter which side of the argument I fall on? Some think it does.

I care about people first, and I'm not ashamed to have that down on paper. Do I deeply care about some obscure insect in the Amazon? Well, I certainly do if it's existence impacts human life, which I'm sure it will, somehow. Regardless of whether or not you are an ecocentric or an anthropocentric, the idea is to get to the same place: a sustainable future. So, let's not kick eachother in the balls while trying to get there. Let's just focus on moving forward.

And to move forward, we have to be honest about what's really going on. The first step to recovery is admitting that we have a problem. Now I hope you are a fan of the late George Carlin (may he rest in peace with the worms) because he is getting a massive plug in this book, even though he won't enjoy a laugh over it.

I felt that his skit that he did on Saving The Planet was so moving and so raw that it had to be shared here for all to see. You may remember it, and if you've never heard it before you are in for a treat. George Carlin was the man.

> "We're so self-important. So self-important. Everybody's going to save something now. "Save the trees, save the bees, save the whales, save those snails." And the greatest arrogance of all: save the planet. What? Are these fucking people kidding me? Save the planet, we don't even know how to take care of ourselves yet. We haven't learned how to care for one another, we're gonna save the fucking planet?"

Agreed. We have no idea how to take care of ourselves *yet*. We listen to our government agencies like the USDA and FDA and the media with corporate sponsorships and corporate lobbyists that are steering us in the absolute wrong direction. I absolutely agree with George Carlin, how the hell do we plan on saving the planet if we don't care to save ourselves? If you ask me, if we can figure out how to save ourselves we will inevitably figure out how to "save the fucking planet." My answer of course is to go Paleo, take care of your body first and read the Paleo Solution by Robb Wolf or the Primal Blueprint by Mark Sisson. Otherwise, it's hard to make an impact if you are diseased and going through life half-dead. It's like they say on the airplane about the oxygen masks, put it over your head first and *then* worry about your fellow passenger. It may seem selfish, but it makes perfect sense. Be selfish.

More George Carlin:

> "I'm getting tired of that shit. Tired of that shit. I'm tired of fucking Earth Day, I'm tired of these self-righteous environmentalists, these white, bourgeois liberals who think the only thing wrong with this country is there aren't enough bicycle paths. People trying to make the world safe for their Volvos. Besides, environmentalists don't give a shit about the planet. They don't care about the planet. Not in the abstract they don't. Not in the abstract they don't. You know what they're interested in? A clean place to live. Their own habitat. They're worried that some day in the future, they might be personally inconvenienced. Narrow, unenlightened self-interest doesn't impress me."

I'm totally in the self-interest camp, and like I said I don't care. (I am the Original Paleo Honey Badger, and I don't care what you think. Thanks, Amy Kubal.) I can't say that I care about other species more than I care about my family or my friends. I can't say I care about a nest of snakes or a den of cubs more than I care about my nieces. But I can say with 100% honesty that I do care about the nest of snakes and the den of cubs because in some way, it does impact the security of my family, my friends, my nieces, the future of my own species, and moreover it impacts *me.*

You see, I've got this biological imperative to procreate and I want a good place for myself and my progeny to live happily and healthily. It's why I personally want everyone to be truly Paleo, because in reality those that support Monocultures-- from CAFOs to cornrows, are screwing over the future of my species and family, and I want it to stop. I'm tired of not having access to good food and I miss chicken, which I will explain later when I talk about Joel Salatin.

I'm tired of seeing red meat vilified as if there was something inherently wrong with a cow, or a deer, a pig, a chicken, or a lamb. I'm tired of the food and pharma industries that screw over people's health and I'm tired of the monoculture-fed, diseased population that has to syphon money from our economy while the bastards that peddle this shit to us get rich. The Himmelstein study indicates that 50% of bankruptcies are from health-care costs. Disease and loss of productivity is ruining our economy. So

yeah, I selfishly want everyone to be Paleo. There's nothing that I do that isn't somehow selfish. Selfishly, I want to save the damn bees, too. Selfishly I want you to save your health. I selfishly want to save the economy. I'm selfish, whatever.

When it was my life or the cow's, I chose mine, anthropocentric bitch that I am. Don't expect me to make any apologies for that, either. I'm an apex predator and I embrace that about myself and species, and I wish we would do our job. I'm tired of Meatless Mondays because I eat meat, and I'm tired of the sterility of my concrete cities so I want to see more flora. I like bike lanes and I also like seeing squirrels, just so that I know I wouldn't starve if I was homeless. Call it unenlightened, call it selfish. Call it whatever you want, but we are on the same sinking ship here. You've got family, you've got friends, you've got a future and you've got a right to be selfish and want what's best for people. That's how I define love. I love people.

I'm also tired of the blatant misleadings of our government and media and I'm tired of the incessant Vegetarian propaganda and ignorance that it breeds. It's screwing everyone over because we can't face the fact that in order to eat, something has to die. It's harsh but it's *life.* And besides, reliance on monocrops is doing more sentient animal killing than grass-fed beef, but I'll tackle that later. Long story short-- I want you to be selfish. If you don't want to be selfish, fine. Be giving, save the bees and the whales, and the obscure microbiota in the Amazon. Whatever it takes to get it done, I don't care, it just needs to be done. Unless you are tired of the human species altogether and want us all to go away... then there's no point in reading this book. If you care about our species, keep reading.

This next bit by George Carlin is my favorite. This is the part that I feel resonates the most with me, and makes me want to act quickly. It compels me to write books that bitches about bagels and whole wheat bread. It reminds me that we are a small and insignificant blip in time, and if we want to prolong this time on the planet we had better get our heads out of our asses and get educated on our current agricultural practices. Denial isn't a river in Africa-- it is the default state of so many disillusioned human beings on the planet, from the Paleos that eat grain-fed CAFO animals down to the Vegetarians that feed their children Kashi for breakfast. Yes my fellow Paleo people, your corn-fed bacon is going to be under attack-- I don't care if it's Organic. Pigs aren't Vegetarians and neither are chickens. The second stupidest bit of human "ingenuity" (second only to the agricultural revolution and our idea that monocultured grains could possibly fit the bill of healthy food) was our idea that feeding grains to animals that don't eat grains was a good idea. Ok, back to George Carlin.

> "Besides, there is nothing wrong with the planet. Nothing wrong with the planet. The planet is fine. The PEOPLE are fucked. Difference. Difference. The planet is fine. Compared to the people, the planet is doing great. Been here four and a half billion years. Did you ever think about the arithmetic? The planet has been here four and a half billion years. We've been here, what, a hundred thousand? Maybe two hundred thousand? And we've only been engaged in heavy industry for a little over two hundred years. Two hundred years versus four and a half

billion. And we have the CONCEIT to think that somehow we're a threat? That somehow we're gonna put in jeopardy this beautiful little blue-green ball that's just a-floatin' around the sun?

The planet has been through a lot worse than us. Been through all kinds of things worse than us. Been through earthquakes, volcanoes, plate tectonics, continental drift, solar flares, sun spots, magnetic storms, the magnetic reversal of the poles…hundreds of thousands of years of bombardment by comets and asteroids and meteors, worldwide floods, tidal waves, worldwide fires, erosion, cosmic rays, recurring ice ages…And we think some plastic bags, and some aluminum cans are going to make a difference? The planet…the planet…the planet isn't going anywhere. WE ARE!

We're going away. Pack your shit, folks. We're going away. And we won't leave much of a trace, either. Thank God for that. Maybe a little styrofoam. Maybe. A little styrofoam. The planet'll be here and we'll be long gone. Just another failed mutation. Just another closed-end biological mistake. An evolutionary cul-de-sac. The planet'll shake us off like a bad case of fleas. A surface nuisance.

The planet will be here for a long, long, LONG time after we're gone, and it will heal itself, it will cleanse itself, 'cause that's what it does. It's a self-correcting system. The air and the water will recover, the earth will be renewed, and if it's true that plastic is not degradable, well, the planet will simply incorporate plastic into a new pardigm: the earth plus plastic. The earth doesn't share our prejudice towards plastic. Plastic came out of the earth. The earth probably sees plastic as just another one of its children. Could be the only reason the earth allowed us to be spawned from it in the first place. It wanted plastic for itself. Didn't know how to make it. Needed us. Could be the answer to our age-old egocentric philosophical question, "Why are we here?" Plastic…asshole.

So, the plastic is here, our job is done, we can be phased out now. And I think that's begun. Don't you think that's already started? I think, to be fair, the planet sees us as a mild threat. Something to be dealt with. And the planet can defend itself in an organized, collective way, the way a beehive or an ant colony can. A collective defense mechanism. The planet will think of something. What would you do if you were the planet? How would you defend yourself against this troublesome, pesky species? Let's see… Viruses. Viruses might be good. They seem vulnerable to viruses. And, uh…viruses are tricky, always mutating and forming new strains whenever a vaccine is developed. Perhaps, this first virus could be one that compromises the immune system of these creatures. Perhaps a human immunodeficiency virus, making them vulnerable to all sorts of other diseases and infections that might come along. And maybe it could be spread sexually, making them a little reluctant to engage in the act of reproduction. Well, that's a poetic note. And it's a start. And I can dream, can't I? See I don't worry about the little things: bees, trees, whales, snails. I think we're part of a greater wisdom than we will ever understand. A higher order. Call it what you

> want. Know what I call it? The Big Electron. The Big Electron…whoooa. Whoooa. Whoooa. It doesn't punish, it doesn't reward, it doesn't judge at all. It just is. And so are we. For a little while."

My point in sharing George Carlin was to take a humorous break for a moment, because things are going to get deep and even though there is some heavy shit in this book, I personally can't take everything too seriously or I am going to crack. Also, because I want everyone to know that we are fragile beings, and so are the other beings on this planet so either we take care of the beings on this planet and ourselves, or the planet will take care of everything for us-- so we need to pay attention. Otherwise, all that will be left is styrofoam and cockroaches. Cockroaches aren't going anywhere, that I can guarantee.

I always thought that it was a feeble, futile, and stupid thing for people to try to convert others, that is, until I became Paleo. Now I want to convert everyone, especially Vegetarians. It's something I feel is extraordinarily important.

Despite the intentions of improving the state of the planet, Vegetarians live in ignorance about agriculture. I am going to suggest that you read the Vegetarian Myth by Lierre Kieth cover to cover, because she has said it better than I ever could-- the vegetarians of the world in search of justice and salvation for the planet are completely ignorant of the mess that they are making.

By the way, I love Lierre Keith and only recently discovered her while reading others' opinions on agricultural sustainability. I wish I had known about her before when I was Vegetarian and trying to prevent animal cruelty. *The Vegetarian Myth* was the first book that I without feeling compelled to take a red marker to the pages to remind me to make mention of the bullshit that I was reading to post on Facebook. I admire Lierre Keith because she is obviously a passionate and empathetic person, having struggled her whole life with the enormous weight on her shoulders trying to reconcile the mistakes of human civilization. A former vegan, she has come to her senses. And like her, I hope to be under attack by the Vegetarian faction for calling out the bullshit if the old adage is true; all publicity is good publicity. I want a war, if a war is what it takes to get them to come back to the table with a grass-fed steak on their plate. I'm not ashamed of that, either. This is one thing I can't sit idly by for. If there's war, there's discussion. We need to have this talk, our own future as a Paleo Community depends on it.

I'd like to be like Robb Wolf here and espouse the "Fuck 'em" sentiment, but I just can't. Not with what I know.

Here's a dose of truth that I hope people take to heart-- "agriculture is the most destructive thing humans have done to the planet, and more of the same won't save us." I cannot possibly improve on that statement. The last time we were in good shape was in the Paleolithic Era. Why else do you think I harp so much on paying attention to Paleolithic Principles when trying to come to any conclusion in sustainable agriculture?

Part 1 Sequence

Seriously, it's so common-sensical it makes me tear my hair out at the thought of a Vegetarian planet. Vegetarianism is good for ruminant animals like cows, not omnivorous people with an ecosystem to keep in balance. Vegetarians like to talk about nature and the natural balance of things...but somehow forget our place before the advent of agriculture.

Ecocentrics, don't you agree that we were most "natural" before the advent of agriculture when we were still hunter-gatherers before we went and defiled every quarry, dammed up every river, tore down every forest, and breed-selected and culled the crap out of wheat, corn, and soy? If hunter-gatherer is our most "natural" state, then why are there so many Ecocentric Vegetarians? This flummoxes me. How can you compartmentalize and stow away *that* bit of information?

More truth: something has to die to feed us. Meat is murder, but then again Bagels are murder, too. It's hard to examine that fact when we look at a bagel because the bagel didn't have a face. Nevertheless, at some juncture that bagel was alive, along with the other animals and insects and birds in the field that died during it's production, but the bagel didn't come with the dead carcasses it left. No, those were left for avian scavengers, so you never saw them, but they were there, picking off what bagel-eaters left behind.

If you look at the soy and the tempeh and the edamame and whole grains on a vegetarian's dinner plate it's hard to tell exactly what died in the process. This makes ignorance easier for Vegetarians. Ignorance is bliss, that I can assure you. How would you take it if your entire identity was tied up in your moral rectitude and you found out you were screwing up way more than the people you had been turning your nose up to for years and years and that you, in fact, were the one completely fucking the planet. Again, ignorance is bliss. For a Vegetarian to really understand the industry their dollars are voting for would be akin to an identity crisis of a middle aged man, but they can't just go buy a new car and get a 20 year old girlfriend to make themselves feel better. No, they'd have to eat meat. There's no artificial band-aid that works here. No easy fix. Even if they did recognize their mistake and made a change, they'd have to deal with nasty glares from their friends that they associated with, they'd have to deal with alienation.

But if you were a Vegetarian and you did see the error in your ways and made the switch to Paleo, you'd be just like what I'm guessing is about 30% of us-- reformed Vegetarians who switched to Paleo because the Vegetarian diet was making us sick. It was just an added bonus that we weren't pandering to unsustainable monocrop industries anymore. Plough cropping, according to Keith, has destroyed 99% of the original humus in Canada, a topsoil disappearance that "rivals global warming as an environmental threat." And for the love of all things good and pure, please don't discredit that last sentence because you think global warming is a non-issue. Argue all you want about what caused it, but don't argue that it's not happening. It's happening.

And we are destroying whole ecosystems routinely for the purpose of crop production, a broad-spectrum screwing over of countless species-- including our own.

Part 1 Sequence